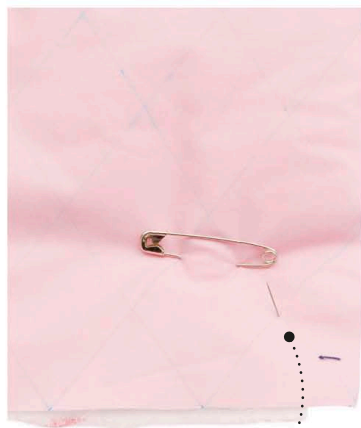


► HAND QUILTING BASICS

Quilting by hand gives a soft look. Straight, even stitches are worked, ideally with the needle at an angle of 90 degrees, and the same stitch length on front and back. Because of the thickness of the quilt layers, the

stitches are executed using a technique known as “rocking” the needle, which uses both hands. Use quilting threads and needles, and wear a thimble on your middle finger and a protective guard underneath.

KNOTTING TO BEGIN



Insert the needle through the fabric and pull it out where you wish to begin

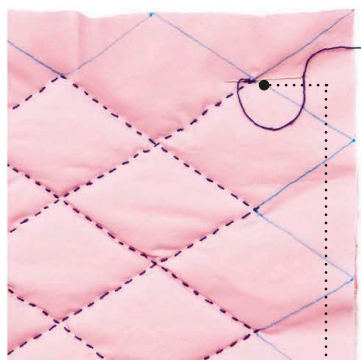
1 Knot a 50cm (20in) length of quilting thread. Take the needle down through the top layer of fabric, about 2.5cm (1in) away from where you wish to start stitching. Bring it out where you wish to begin.



Pull the knot gently through the fabric

2 Pull the thread gently until the knot pops through the top layer of fabric but not hard enough to bring it out again. The knot will bury itself in the wadding and be virtually undetectable.

FINISHING OFF



1 To secure the thread at the end, take a small backstitch through the top layer and pull the thread through to the top. Make a French knot close to the end of the stitching. Secure the wraps with your finger and pull the knot tight.



2 Insert the needle point into the top layer only, next to where the thread emerges and in the opposite direction to the stitching. Slide the needle within the wadding and bring it out about 2cm (¾in) from the end of the stitching. Gently pull the French knot through into the wadding.



3 Carefully cut the thread close to the surface and let the tail sink into the wadding.